

Light

Fire gave early people light, which is important because our eyes do not see well in the dark.

Having light allowed people to hunt and find shelters at night. It let people explore deep caves that gave good shelter.

Cooking

Eating cooked food helped to make people healthier, as food that has been cooked carries less disease. Cooked food is also quicker and easier to digest. The extra energy may have helped the brain to grow bigger, too.



Cooking pot

Protection

Fire helped protect early humans from predatory animals, such as wolves or bears. They would have been scared of the light from the fire.



Gray wolf

Step 2

The tip of the drill was placed into one of the notches of the hearth. The bow string was wrapped around the drill. The drill was spun by moving the bow back and forth.



Piece of wood to protect the hand

Bow looped around drill

Step 3

As the fire-maker spun the drill faster, smoke appeared, and a red-hot ember formed. He then placed the burning ember by hand into the tinder bundle and blew on it.



Ember starts to smoke

Step 4

He continued to blow on the ember until it burst into a small flame. He set it on the ground and added the kindling, until it flared into a crackling fire.



Place the burning ember on the ground